



DEALING WITH A CRISIS

- › **Keep a cool head** when you need to act quickly, and take a moment to think about what you are doing.
- › **Establish your priorities** to ensure that your actions are likely to have the best impact on the situation.
- › **Communicate clearly** with precise instructions so that everyone understands exactly what is expected of them.
- › **Manage people under pressure** by listening to their concerns but remaining calm and reassuring to prevent any panic.
- › **Stay positive** and be alert to the unexpected; sometimes a crisis can open new opportunities.

“Many small businesses across sectors came into the COVID-19 crisis with low financial resilience.”

US small-business recovery after the COVID-19 crisis, McKinsey & Company, 2020



Identify possible solutions

When figuring out solutions, think about ways of limiting the damage and how you could prevent it from happening in the first place. For example, ensuring your data is backed up with adequate security is always a good idea.



Analyze the implications

Consider the consequences of your proposed actions. Additional cost is the most likely implication, but your plans could also affect your staff morale or your business reputation if you do not adequately take into account the needs of clients, colleagues, or suppliers.